Assignment 6: Pragmatics

Ling 201 – Fall 2026

(100 pts total)

Please **do not use external sources such as the internet or AI to find the answers**. If you need an **extension**, please ask before the deadline.

Part 1. Presupposition Triggers

For each sentence, identify **one** definite expression (proper names, pronouns, or "the X" phrases, etc.) it contains and state the presupposition brought about by the definite expression. Then identify one **other** presupposition trigger, identify the type of trigger (factive verb, iterative expression, change-of-state verb, cleft), and state the presupposition it triggers. *(6 points/item, 24 points total)*

Example *Jackie ate another cookie.*

definite expression:	*Jackie*
presupposition:	*Someone exists named Jackie*
other presupposition trigger:	*another*
trigger type:	*iterative expression*
presupposition:	*Jackie had previously eaten a cookie.*

1. Beryl started reading the paper.

   definite expression:

   presupposition:

   other presupposition trigger:

   trigger type:

   presupposition:

2. Jeongjae texted my brother again.

   definite expression:
   presupposition:
   other presupposition trigger:
   trigger type:
   presupposition:

3. She realized that she had won the lottery.

   definite expression:
   presupposition:
   other presupposition trigger:
   trigger type:
   presupposition:

4. What Junwoo wanted was a new job.

   definite expression:
   presupposition:
   other presupposition trigger:
   trigger type:
   presupposition:

Part 2. Conversational Implicatures

For each conversation, identify the **conversational implicature** in Merlin's utterance. Then state the **flouted conversational maxim** (Quantity, Quality, Relevance, Manner) that leads to the implicature and **explain why** that Maxim is relevant. (6 *points/item, 30 points total*)

Example **Arthur**: Did you finish all of your homework?
Merlin: I finished my stats homework.

implicature: *Merlin finished only his stats homework but not other homework.*
maxim: *Maxim of Quantity*
explanation: *Merlin gives less information than Arthur asked for.*

1. **Arthur**: I could really go for a coffee.
   Merlin: There's a café down the street.

   implicature:

   maxim:

   explanation:

2. **Arthur**: I'm going to spend all of my savings on videogames.
   Merlin (unimpressed): What a great idea!

   implicature:

   maxim:

   explanation:

3. **Arthur**: Did you do the reading for phonology class?
   Merlin: I read the first page.

   implicature:

   maxim:

   explanation:

Arthur: Why is your face all red?
Merlin: I put on some lotion and got a rash.

implicature:

maxim:

explanation:

4. **Arthur**: Are you going to the beach this weekend?
   Merlin: It's going to be chilly.

implicature:

maxim:

explanation:

Part 3. Entailments vs. Implicatures

For each statement in (a), an **entailment** and an **implicature** are given. **Identify** which is which, and **explain** your answer using the cancellation **OR** reinforcement test.

Example

(a) *Merlin speaks English, Kazakh and Chinese.*

(b) *Merlin speaks exactly three languages*.

(c) *Merlin speaks English.*

(b) is an **implicature** of the sentence (a), and it can be **cancelled** by saying "*Merlin speaks English, Kazakh and Chinese. Actually, he also speaks German*." This sentence makes sense and cancels (b), which suggests that (b) is an implicature.

(c) is an **entailment** of the sentence (a), and if sentence (a) is true, sentence (c) must be true as well. It cannot be **cancelled** by saying "*Merlin speaks English, Kazakh and Chinese. Actually, he does not speak Kazakh*." This sentence is **contradictory** and does not make sense, which suggests that (c) is not an implicature but an entailment.

(6 points/question, 36 points total)

1. (a) Sukchan finished today's work.

   (b) Sukchan worked today.

   (c) Sukchan will not work more today.

2. (a) Even I can solve the puzzle.

   (b) The puzzle is easy to solve.

   (c) I can solve the puzzle.

3. (a) Utku forgot to switch off the stove.

   (b) Utku didn't switch off the stove.

   (c) Utku was supposed to switch off the stove.

4. (a) Surprisingly, Fahad came to the party.

   (b) We did not expect that Fahad would come.

   (c) Fahad came to the party.

5. (a) The newest model is the cheapest of all models.

   (b) The older models are more expensive.

   (c) The newest model is a good deal.

6. (a) Quartz and Tetsu had dinner and went to a movie.

   (b) They ate a meal.

   (c) They had dinner first and went to a movie second.

Part 4 Real-life Implicature

Imagine that Merlin and Arthur have a plan to throw Lancelot a surprise party at work. It is Merlin's job to meet Lancelot for lunch at a local restaurant to get him out of the office, and Arthur's job to decorate as soon as he leaves. Merlin phones Arthur and says, "The eagle has landed." **What Maxim is Merlin flouting? What does his utterance implicate?** *(10 points)*

Extra Credit

This part is **optional**. If you attempt it, you will receive *at least 1 extra point* on top of your grade. Up to ***5 points*** may be awarded based on the quality of your answer. *(5 points)*

Here is a dialog excerpt from the 1945 motion picture *The Thin Man Goes Home*. The scene is in a shop that sells painting and Nick Charles is leaving the shop.

NICK CHARLES:	Well, thank you very much. Goodbye now.
SHOPKEEPER:	I beg your pardon?
NICK CHARLES:	I said, goodbye now.
SHOPKEEPER:	"Goodbye now?" There's no sense to that! Obviously
	it's now! I mean, you wouldn't say "goodbye tomorrow"
	or "goodbye two hours ago!"
NICK CHARLES:	You got hold of somethin' there, brother.
SHOPKEEPER:	I've got hold of some…I haven't got hold of anything…
	And I'm not your brother!

Analyse this dialogue, intended to be humorous (one assumes), in light of Grice's maxims.